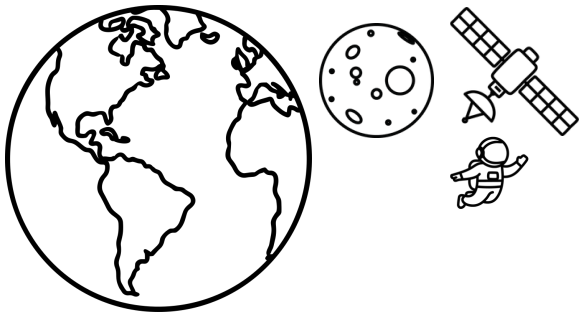
EARTH & SPACE SCIENCE



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COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course follows the New York State Science Learning Standards for Earth and Space Sciences. Emphasis in this course will be placed on an investigative approach. The standards focuses on three-dimensional learning, where students act as scientists to analyze complex systems such as plate tectonics, climate patterns, and stellar evolution. Students explore the deep history of Earth through the rock and fossil records while investigating modern challenges like resource management and natural disasters.

COURSE OUTLINE

The curriculum is divided into core areas that require students to observe phenomena, analyze data, and apply scientific principles:

- **Space Systems:** The life span of the sun, nuclear fusion, the Big Bang theory, and the motion of orbiting objects.
- **History of the Earth:** Plate tectonics, the rock cycle, and evidence of the planet's geologic history.
- **Earth's Systems:** The interactions between the geosphere, atmosphere, hydrosphere, and biosphere.
- **Weather and Climate:** Atmospheric dynamics, ocean currents, and climate change mechanisms.
- **Human Sustainability:** Natural hazards, resource management, and the impact of human activities on environmental systems.

LAB REQUIREMENT

The New York State Education Department requires students to complete a minimum of **1,200 minutes** of hands-on laboratory experience with satisfactory written lab reports to qualify for the Earth and Space Sciences Regents Exam. Students must complete these lab hours and have them successfully on file, typically by June 1st of the testing year.

The New York State Education Department (NYSED) additionally outlines specific, **mandatory investigations** that must be included within those 1,200 minutes. The 3 investigations are titled: Unearthing Mars, The Sky is the Limit and Ripple Effect.

Lab minutes will be tracked each quarter, and your progress toward completing the required lab minutes will be reflected on your report card. Labs not submitted by the end of the quarter will not be accepted. Failure to complete the required lab minutes and State Investigation requirements will result in being barred from taking the Regents Exam.

SUPPLIES

- A 2 pocket folder used only for Earth and Space Science. This will hold current assignments that we are working on in class and in lab. I will hold onto your turned work throughout the quarter.
- Charged Chromebook
- Pens & Pencils

GRADING

Unit Tests	40%
Quizzes	20%
Labs	10%
Assignments	25%
Engagement	5%

LATE WORK POLICY

- Assignments may be submitted after the due date **until the next Fix It Friday**. After that deadline, missing assignments will receive a zero. **Due Dates will be posted on Canvas.**
- **Late work is graded by the next Fix It Friday***, so please allow time for grades to be updated.
- Late assignments will receive a **25% penalty**.
- Missing assessments (tests/quizzes) must be completed in the Academic Assistance Center **(AAC)** as soon as possible and should be your top priority.
- You must submit a late work form with your late work to be accepted.

***Fix It Friday:** Every other Friday, students will receive a Missing Assignment Report to review with a parent or guardian. The signed report must be returned the following class day. This is your opportunity to identify missing work, make a plan to get caught up, and check your current academic standing.

WHAT TO DO WHEN YOU ARE ABSENT

- A **"While You Were Out" sheet** will outline what you missed and what needs to be completed.
- A weekly lesson plan outline will be posted on **Canvas**.
- Your "While You Were Out" sheet will be attached to any paper assignments from the class folder.
- The more you are absent, the more difficult it becomes to catch up. Stay on top of missed work to avoid falling behind.

EXPECTATIONS

- **Be on time.** Arriving on time is a sign of respect for your teacher and classmates and ensures you don't miss important instructions.
- **Start the warm-up immediately.** Be in your seat and working as soon as the bell rings.
- **Listen when others are speaking.** Do not talk while I or a classmate is speaking.
- **Use class time wisely.** Avoid sleeping or other behaviors that waste valuable learning time. Homework is only assigned when classwork is not completed during the allotted class time. However, students who choose not to stay on task will be expected to complete the work at home.
- **Remain seated until dismissed.** The bell does not dismiss class. Stay seated until I dismiss you.
- **Take ownership of your education.** I am here to teach, guide, and support you, but your success depends on the effort and choices you make each day.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

- All work submitted must be your own. Cheating, plagiarism, copying another student's work, or unauthorized collaboration is not permitted.
- AI tools may only be used with teacher permission. Unauthorized use of AI or any form of academic dishonesty may result in a zero on the assignment and additional disciplinary consequences.

COMMUNICATION & SUPPORT

- **Communication is important!** If you have questions or need help, you can contact me through email or the Canvas Inbox. While I do not respond outside of school hours, I will reply within 24 hours on school days.
- There is no textbook for this course. Additional resources will be posted on Canvas.
- If you need extra help, I am available after school until 3:25 p.m. Please arrange to stay in advance whenever possible.

EARTH AND SPACE SCIENCE SYLLABUS 2026-2027

Dear Parent/Guardian of _____*(please write student name)* Period:____
Thank you for taking the time to review this course syllabus with your child. By signing below, you acknowledge that you have read and discussed the expectations, classroom policies, grading procedures, and course information outlined in this syllabus.

Throughout the school year, there may be additional assignments or documents that require a parent/guardian signature. These are intended to keep you informed and strengthen communication between home and school.

I look forward to partnering with you to make this a successful school year. If you have any questions or concerns, please don't hesitate to contact me at atroutman@ktufsd.org.

I would appreciate it if you could take a few moments to answer the questions below. Your responses will help me better support your child and foster strong communication throughout the school year.

Best email address: _____

Best phone number:_____

How would you prefer to be contacted regarding your child's progress or important updates?
□ Email □ Phone □ Canvas □ Other: _____

What has your child's experience with science been like in the past?

_____

_____

Is there anything you would like me to know to better support your child this year?

_____

_____

Is there anything else you would like me to know about your child (learning preferences, strengths, interests, challenges, etc.) that would help me support them in class?

_____

_____

Student Signature _____

Parent Name _____

Parent Signature_____

Name: _____ Period: _____

SYLLABUS HUNT

It is your responsibility to read the entire course syllabus. Complete the questions below as you read to help you focus on the most important information and better understand the expectations for this course.

1.What is your teacher's name?

2.What is your lab teacher's name? (Check your schedule!)

3.What day do you have lab?
(Check your schedule!)

4.What period do you have lab?
(Check your schedule!)

5.How many minutes of laboratory work are required to take the Regents Exam?

6.What are the names of the three required State Investigations?

7.What happens if you do not complete all three State Investigations and/or the required lab minutes?

8.What category is worth the largest percentage of your grade?

9.Where can you find the weekly lesson plans?

10.What document will tell you exactly what you missed?

11.How much is deducted from a late assignment?

12.Where must missing tests and quizzes be completed?

13.When will late work be graded?

14.Until when is late work accepted?

15.What should you do as soon as you sit down?

16.True or False: The bell dismisses the class.

17.When will you have homework?

18.How long should you expect to wait for a response to an email or Canvas message?

19.Who is in charge of your education?